A land mass that holds utmost importance to Jain Mythology, where non-violence, peace and truth have been understood and practiced for thousands of years, where 17 of the 24 Tirthankaras of current chovisi, were born and is home of 67 Jin Kalyanak Tirths. The innumerable Jain Shrines that dot the state of Uttar Pradesh speak of a myriad of intimate associations with the lives of Jain Tirthankars. A power-house of spiritual energy that has attracted and moulded sentiments of millions of people across the nation and around the world.

DEOGARH, LALITPUR

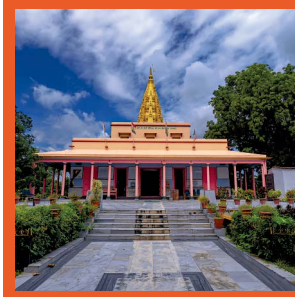
Dating back to the 8th-17th century, the fort complex consists of 31 Jain temples housing around 2,000 sculptures which is in fact the largest such collection in the world. The most famous of the Jain temples in the fort is the Shantinath temple, which is believed to have been built before 862 AD. It is also considered the most important Jain religious site in Uttar Pradesh. Apart from Deogarh, Jain pilgrimage places in the state can be found in Meerut, Varanasi, Muzaffarnagar, Baghpat, Bateshwar, Kampil, Sarnath, and Khukhundoo. Hastinapur, on the other hand, boasts a number of Jain religious centres making it one of the top sites for a pilgrimage tour in Uttar Pradesh for Jain pilgrims.
These 31 Jain temples are somewhat later in origin than the Vishnu temple, but are no less remarkable. They are situated inside the Fort of Karnali on the hills overlooking the Betwa. The site was a Jain centre from the 8th to the 17th century. The temples abound in panels depicting scenes from Jain mythology, Tirthankara images, pillars, tablets, Jain images visible from all sides and pillars carved with thousand Jain figures.

OTHER DESTINATIONS RELATED OF JAIN CULTURE IN UP



AYODHYA

The city of Lord Rama has a special place in the hearts of Hindus but it is a venerated pilgrimage destination for Jains also accredited for its Digambar Jain Temple. It is the birth place of Jain Tirthankaras, namely Rishabhanatha, Ajitanatha, Abhinandananatha, Sumatinatha and Anantanatha.



VARANASI

Parshvanatha was born here in Varanasi and the city is famous for many heritage sites related to Jainism. Jain Ghat in Varanasi holds a special significance for the Jains as they believe that the 7th Jain Tirthankara was born in the neighbourhood of this ghat. Digambar Jain Temple in Sarnath is one of the distinguished Jain temples. It houses beautiful frescoes, depicting the life of Mahavir, the founder of the present day Jain religion. Tourists from across the country reach here to garner some moments of solace and sanctity.



BAGPAT

Trilok Teerth Dham is a Jain temple in Bagpat, built in the shape of the Jain Emblem. This remarkably aesthetic temple is 317 feet in height, out of which, 100 feet is below the ground, and the rest above it!



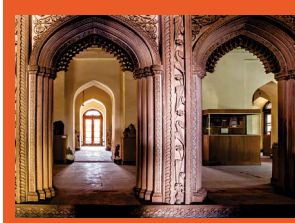
PRAYAGRAJ

The Sangam Nagri has an iconic importance for Hindus but very few people know that it has great importance for Jainis also. The Mahaveer Rishabhdev JainTemple in Prayagraj, leaves the visitors awestruck with its enticing structure and sanctity. It is one of the renowned Jain temples in Uttar Pradesh



SRAVASTI

Mahet is one of the most famous Buddhist shrines located in Sravasti. This place marks the birthplace of Sambhavnath, the third Jain Tirthankara. A place where the spirituality looms in the air. Besides being an important pilgrimage destination for Hindus and Buddhists, Varanasi stands for Jainism also. Thousands of Jain faith believers visit Shri Parshvanth Ji Digambar Jain Temple every year.



MATHURA

The saintly repose of Mathura acquires the merits of all sects and beliefs. The Jain Museum here illustrates an excellent corpus of artefacts and sculptures excavated in the fractions of discoveries. It houses an amazing collection of ancient ornaments, Jain sculptures, stones and manuscripts. It is a must see for history lovers also.



GORAKHPUR

Shri Digambar Jain Temple of Gorakhpur is situated in Arya Nagar. This temple is estimated to be nearly 300 years old and houses a big corpus of religious texts and scriptures related to Jainism.